



**free will
and
determinism**

against
compatibilist
free will

against
incompatibilist
free will

The best way to bring out this challenge is to pose a question about the conditions under which free will is possible.

We are all familiar with the idea that some facts about ourselves are determined by factors outside of our control. Obvious examples include things like hair color and height, which are determined by our genetic inheritance. But we often also explain personality traits, and likes and dislikes, in terms of both our genetic inheritance and the way in which we were raised. Others might be explained in terms of various features of our environment.

Our problem today is the challenge to free will posed by determinism.

Suppose that **everything** about me — my likes and dislikes, my choices and decisions — is ultimately determined by factors outside of my control. Is that compatible with me having free will?



yes



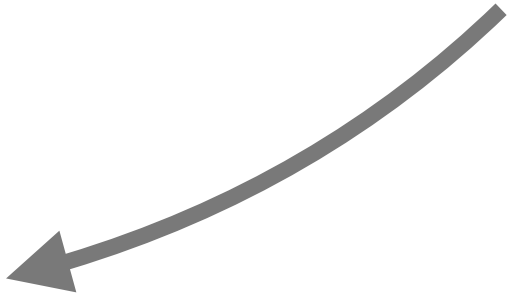
no

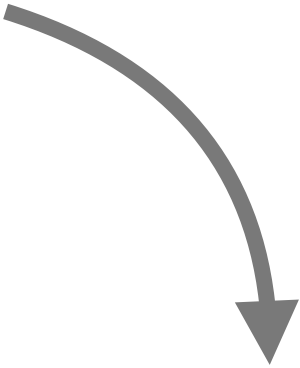
Then free will is compatible with determinism, since that would be just one way in which stuff about me could be determined by factors outside of my control.

This called a compatibilist
view of free will.

Then free will is incompatible with determinism, since if determinism were true everything about me would be ultimately determined by factors outside of my control.

This called a libertarian view
of free will.





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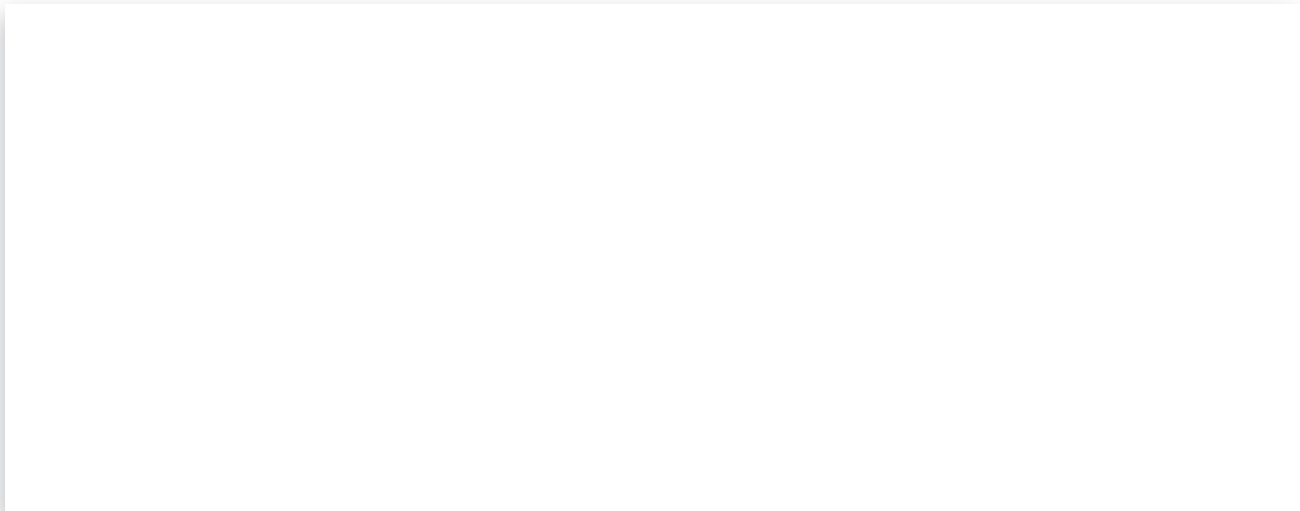
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But we often also explain personality traits, attitudes and dislikes, in terms of

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might explain differences of various features of environment.



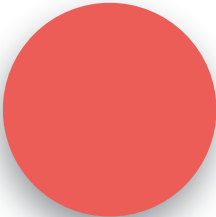
Suppose that everything about me —

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which stuffs out the middle

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determini·sma·ver·ter·ue

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Then free will is incompatible



Third-party interview

offfreewin.



4. If determinism is true, the laws of

varlatatie + the last of the

nature say that if DINS ARE happy,

3. If determined, the only one

2. None has any choice about DIDS. ATJR.

5. No one has any choice about what the laws

1. No one has any choice about events which

then DECISION happens. (3)



happened in the distant past.

of interest.

~ If none has about choice about whether P,

future is not as it was with the state of the

about whether @.

6. If $\det A$ is true, then A has any

and none has any choice about whether,

theorie about the fact that if DNR

choice about DECISION (2, 6, 7)



C. If determinist is true, then no one has any

if P , then Q , then one has any choice

then DECISION. (4,5)

one has any choice about the past, no

choice principle, and determinism

This argument seems to show that the

choice about the laws of nature, then no

combination of four - that No

rules out free will.

seems to show that if determinism is

true, there are no free actions — and

Since the first three of these theses

seem quite plausible, the argument

hence that free will is incompatible with



dearminism.







1. Freewill is incompatible with determinism.

2. If Libertarianism is true, there is no free

Wili.

0: There is no fire will.



Real/|the master argument:

The consequence argument is a defense of premise (1). If you believe

in free will, and find the consequent argument persuasive, it looks

tempting to reply to the master argument by denying premise (2).



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A red circular button with a slight drop shadow, containing the text "against incompatibilist free will" in white, lowercase, sans-serif font.

against
incompatibilist
free will

We can lay out this puzzle in terms of the following master argument against the

reality of free will.



1. Free will is incompatible with determinism.

2. If Libertarianism is true, there is no free

Wili.



0. There is no fire in.



believe in free will rejects premise (2).

Compatibility believers in free will reject premise (1). An incompatibilist

for (2), and one for (3).

or premise (3) is true. We're now going to look at two arguments — one

Now, so far we have been given no reason to think that either premise (2)

A large, solid orange circle with a subtle drop shadow, centered on a white background. Inside the circle, the text "against compatibilist free will" is written in white, bold, lowercase letters, arranged in three lines.

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incompatible with both determinism and indeterminism, and hence impossible.

More precisely, our topic is the relationship between freedom and

determinism, and a cluster of arguments which seem to show that free will is

What is 'determinism'?

Consider a timeline of the history of the universe.

every/after time.

universe at one time, the laws of nature tell you exactly what will happen at

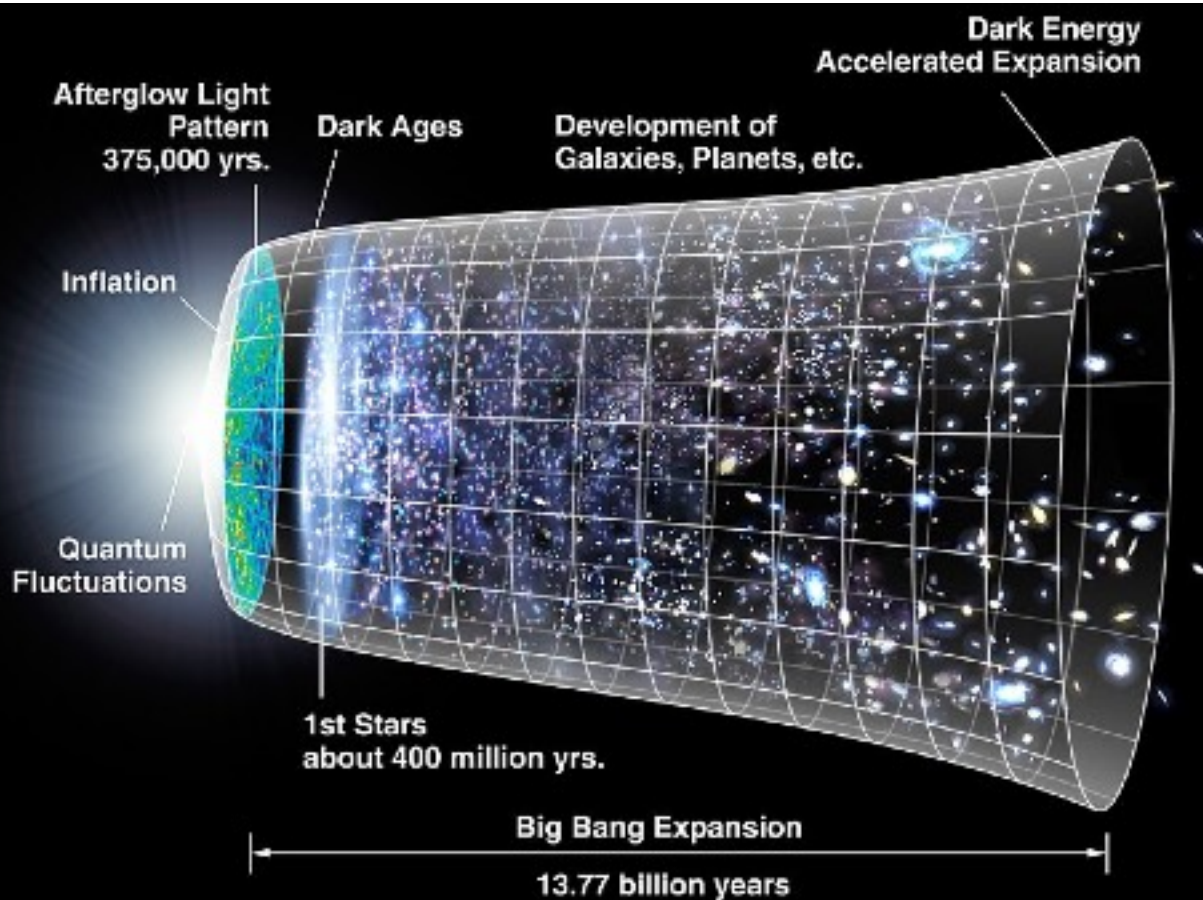
What feminism says is that, given a full specification of the



'Determinism is that only one

containing the state of things at a given

ment is consistent with the law



nature. It is then an open question whether we could have free will in a

how we are using the term. Determinism is a thesis about the laws of the

Sometimes people use 'determinism' as a name for the thesis that there is no

world with deterministic laws.

free will, that determinism rules out free will by definition. That is not

Let's focus in on that question:

Our topic today is the challenge to free will posed by determinism.